MILITARY SPECIFICATION

PRIMERS, PERCUSSION, M38A1 AND M38B2 LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling, and packing for percussion primers M38A1 andM38B2.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-P-116 - Preservation, Methods of
MIL-P-223 - Powder, Black
MIL-A-2550 - Ammunition and Special Weapons, General Specification for
MIL-I-45607 - Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105)
MIL-STD-109 - Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions
MIL-STD-1235 - Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

FSC: 1390

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DRAWINGS

ORDNANCE CORPS

8839378 - Primer, Percussion, M38B2 Assembly
8839379 - Primer, Percussion, M38A1 Assembly
8858939 - Box, Packing, Ammunition, for Primers M38A1 or M38B2.
8858940 - Box, Set-up, Packing Ammunition for Primers

PUBLICATIONS

ORDNANCE CORPS

IEL-8839378 or 8839379 - Index of Inspection Equipment Lists

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.-Material and parts shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

3.2 Primer assembly.-The primer assembly shall comply with all requirements specified on drawing (dwg.) 8839378 or 8839379, as applicable and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

3.3 Moisture content of black powder.-The moisture content of black powder at the loading station at the time of loading, shall not exceed 0.5 percent, when determined as specified in 4.3.3.

3.4 Head assembly

3.4.1 Non-functioning.-The head assembly shall not function by an applied energy of 47.52 inch ounces, minimum (min.) when tested as specified in 4.3.1.1.

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3.4.2 Functioning.-The head assembly shall function by an applied energy of 159.20 inch ounces, maximum (max.) when tested as specified in 4.3.1.2.

3.5 Primer assembly

3.5.1 Functioning.-The primer assembly shall function without audible hangfire, when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.5.2 Pressure resistance.-The primer assemblies shall withstand a pressure of 60,000 minus 2,000 pounds per square inch (psi), piezo-equivalent pressure (pep) without evidence of rupture, blowback around the battery cup and firing plug, or any part of the primer become detached, when tested as specified in 4.3.2.

3.6 Workmanship.-All parts shall be dry and free of cracks, chips, dirt, grease, rust and other foreign material. The cleaning method shall not be injurious to any of the parts, nor shall the parts be contaminated by the cleaning agents.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 General quality assurance provisions.-Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL-STD-109 in order to define terms used herein. The provisions of Specification MIL-A-2550 shall apply.

4.1.1 Submission of product.-At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

a. A statement that the lot complies with all of the quality assurance provisions specified within this specification.

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b. Number of units of product inspected.
c. Results obtained, by defect code, for all inspection performed.
d. Drawing, specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.
e. Certificates of compliance on all material purchased by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents.
f. Number of items in the lot.
g. Date submitted.

The certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.1.2 Government verification.-Using the contractor's written quality assurance procedure, this detail specification, the applicable drawings and other contractual documents as a guide, the Government inspector shall verify at unscheduled intervals all quality assurance operations performed by the contractor. Verification will be performed to the extent necessary to assure compliance with the contractual requirements. Severity of Government inspection of individual characteristics will be directly related to the seriousness of the classification assigned. In no instance will a characteristic classified "critical" be accepted solely on the basis of the contractor's records.

4.2 Inspection provisions

4.2.1 Lot formation.-A lot shall consist of percussion primers produced by one manufacturer in one unchanged process, in accordance with the same drawing, same drawing revision, same specification, and same specification revision. Drawing, specification, and process changes not affecting safety, performance or fit as determined by the Government shall not necessitate changing the lot number. Product shall be submitted for inspection in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 (or Standard MIL-STD-1235, when applicable). Each lot shall contain:

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a. Metal parts of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

b. Black powder from not more than one lot from one manufacturer.

c. Primer, percussion M61 (herein after referred to as primer element) of one lot interfix number from one manufacturer.

4.2.2 Examination.-Inspection for Critical defects shall be 100 percent. Sampling plans and procedures for Major and Minor defects shall be in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-105 except that continuous sampling plans in accordance with Standard MIL-STD-1235 may be used if approved by the procuring activity. Also, at the option of the procuring activity, AQL's and sampling plans may be applied to individual characteristics listed using an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect and an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect. Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.2.1 Head, prior to assembling battery cup and firing plug (see dwgs. 8839378 or 8839379).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No. (see 6.2)
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Percussion element missing, cocked or inverted	Visual	10001
Minor:	AQL 1.0 percent		
201.	Seal between percussion element and head missing or incomplete	Visual	10002
202.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.6)	Visual	10003

4.2.2.2 Head, prior to assembling to body (see dwgs. 8839378 or 8839379).

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Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:			
1.	Firing plug or battery cup above flush with surface of head	Straight-Edge	02001
Major:	AQL 0.65 percent		
101.	Firing plug missing or inverted	Visual	02002
102.	Flash hole in head completely obstructed	Visual	02003
103.	Battery cup loose or missing	Manual	02004
Minor:	None defined		

4.2.2.3 Body, prior to assembly of liner and head assembly (see dwgs. 8839378 or 8839379).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:			
1.	Any flash hole missing from body	Visual	03001
Major:	None defined		
Minor:	AQL 0.65 percent		
201.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.6)	Visual	03002

4.2.2.4 Body, prior to assembling head assembly (see dwgs. 8839378 or 8839379).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		

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Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Weight of charge	Balance	04001
102.	Liner fails to cover all holes	Visual	04002
Minor:	AQL 1.0 percent		
201.	Foreign matter in charge	Visual	04003
202.	Depth of diaphragm	Gage	04004

4.2.2.5 Assembly, prior to crimping (see dwg. 8839458).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	None defined		
Minor:	AQL 0.40 percent		
201.	Thread sealing compound missing	Visual	05001

4.2.2.6 Assembly (see dwgs. 8839378 or 8839379).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Head assembly loose on body	Manual	06001
*102.	Any flash hole not completely sealed	Visual	06002
Minor:	AQL 2.5 percent		
201.	Total length, max.	Gage	06003
202.	Diameter of flange, max.	Gage	06004
203.	Diameter at front end, max.	Gage	06005
204.	Crimp of body to head missing or incomplete	Visual	06006

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205.	Marking misleading or unidentifiable	Visual	06007
206.	Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.6)	Visual	06008

*Sketches 1 2 and 3 on Figure 1 indicate acceptable primers. Furthermore, a primer with holes displaying the conditions 4, 5 or 6 may be classed acceptable provided that the visible liner is thoroughly impregnated with paint or lacquer and not more than 20 percent of the holes have this condition.

4.2.2.7 Set-up box, prior to sealing (see dwg. 8858940).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	None defined		
Minor:	AQL 1.5 percent		
201.	Any packing material missing	Visual	07001
202.	Primer missing	Visual	07002
203.	Separator damaged to the extent that primers touch each other	Visual	07003

4.2.2.8 Sealed set-up box (see dwg. 8858940).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical:	None defined		
Major:	None defined		
Minor:	AQL 1.5 percent		
201.	Sealing strip torn, incomplete badly wrinkled, or otherwise fails to seal carton	Visual	08001

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202.	Carton torn, cut or punctured.....	Visual	08002
203.	Marking missing, misleading or unidentifiable.....	Visual	08003
204.	Contents loose.....	Manual	08004

4.2.2.9 Sealed barrier bag (see dwg. 8858940).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical: None defined			
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Bag punctured, torn or cut.....	Visual	09001
102.	Seal mislocated or incomplete.....	Visual	09002
Minor:	AQL 0.65 percent		
201.	Marking misleading or unidentifiable.....	Visual	09003

4.2.2.10 Packing box, prior to sealing (see dwg. 8858939).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical: None defined			
Major:	AQL 0.40 percent		
101.	Carton missing.....	Visual	10001
Minor: None defined			

4.2.2.11 Packing box, sealed (see dwg. 8858939).

Categories	Defects	Method of Inspection	Code No.
Critical: None defined			

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Major:	AQL 0.65 percent		
101.	Box broken, board loose or protruding nail	Visual	11001
102.	Strapping missing, broken or loose	Visual	11002
103.	Cover improperly assembled	Visual	11003
Minor:	AQL 1.5 percent		
201.	Marking misleading or unidentifiable	Visual	11004
202.	Strapping improperly engaged or mislocated	Visual	11005
203.	Contents loose	Visual	11006

4.2.3 Testing

4.2.3.1 Head assembly

4.2.3.1.1 Non functioning (see 3.4.1) Critical defect - Code No. 02005.

4.2.3.1.1.1 Beginning with the first lot produced, and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the acceptance criteria specified, a sample of 150 head assemblies shall be randomly selected from each lot for the test. If any sample fails to comply with the requirement the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.1.

4.2.3.1.1.2 After three consecutive lots have met the criteria of 4.2.3.1.1.1, a sample of 50 head assemblies shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If one or more primers fails to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.1 using equipment in accordance with 4.2.4. Primers subjected to this test shall be destroyed.

4.2.3.1.2 Functioning (see 3.4.2) Major defect - Code No. 02006.

4.2.3.1.2.1 Beginning with the first lot produced and continuing until three consecutive lots have complied with the

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applicable requirements specified two hundred and fifty samples shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If three or more primers fail to comply with the applicable requirements, the lot shall be rejected. If one or two defects are found, a second sample of five hundred primers shall be tested. If the combined number of defectives in both the first and second sample is three or more, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.2 using equipment in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.3.1.2.2 After three consecutive lots have met the criteria of 4.2.3.1.2.1, a sample of 125 primers shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If two or more primers fail to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected. If only one defect is found, a second sample of 250 primers shall be tested. If the combined number of defectives in both the first and second sample is two or more, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.2 using equipment in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.3.2 Primer assembly functioning and pressure resistance (see 3.5) Major defect - Code No. 06009.-A sample of 25 primers shall be selected from each lot for this test. If any primer fails to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.2 using equipment that is in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.3.3 Check test for deterioration of primer element.-If the total elapsed time between original acceptance of the primer element lot and the assembly of that lot into the primer exceeds two years, or if the primer elements have been subjected to adverse conditions for any period of time since previous test, the primer element lot shall be subjected to and must satisfactorily pass the check test for deterioration specified in the applicable primer element specification immediately before the primer element lot is assembled into the primers (see 6.5).

4.2.3.4 Moisture content of black powder (see 3.3) Major defect - Code No. 04005.-A sample of black powder shall be randomly selected at the loading station from each eight hours

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production. The black powder shall be tested as specified in 4.3.3 and any failure to comply with the applicable requirement shall be cause for rejection of the eight hours production represented by the sample.

4.2.3.5 Heat seal test for sealed bag (see dwg. 8858940) Major defect - Code No. 09004.-Sampling, acceptance criteria and test procedures for this test shall be in accordance with Specification MIL-P-116.

4.2.4 Inspection Equipment.-Index of Inspection Equipment Lists Numbers IEL 8839378 or 8839379 identifies the inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed in this section. The contractor shall design inspection equipment in accordance with the instructions in paragraph 6.3.

4.2.4.1 Government rights to documentation.-Inspection equipment drawings and lists provided and revised in accordance with the requirements of the IEL may be used by DOD activities for design, procurement, manufacture, testing, evaluation, production and receiving inspection, overhaul, shipping, storage, identification of stock, ordering and storage of replacement parts, inspection of items at overhaul, general maintenance of equipment, construction, survey and wherever inspection equipment drawings are needed.

4.2.4.2 Supply and maintenance.-Supply and maintenance of the equipment listed on the IEL shall be in accordance with Specification MIL-I-45607.

4.2.4.3 Government use of contractor's inspection and test equipment.-The contractor shall make available to the Government all inspection and test equipment necessary for determining conformance with contract requirements. Personnel for operating the equipment, and verification of its accuracy, shall be supplied by the contractor for the performance of examination or test by the Government.

4.3 Test methods and procedures

4.3.1 Head assembly

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4.3.1.1 Non-functioning.-The loaded heads, prior to assembling to the body, shall be assembled into the test fixture (see 4.2.4). A steel ball weighing a min. of 7.92 ounces shall be dropped from a height to give the required impact force (approximately 6 inches).

4.3.1.2 Functioning.-The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.1 except that the weight of the ball shall be 7.96 ounces maximum, and the height shall be adjusted to give the required impact force (approximately 20 inches).

4.3.2 Primer assembly functioning and pressure resistance.- The loaded primer assemblies shall be assembled into the test fixture (see 4.2.4). The fixture shall be activated and observation shall be made for firing and audible hangfire. Upon completion of firing the primer shall be removed and observation shall be made for ruptured and broken or detached parts. (see 6.6 and 6.7)

4.3.3 Determination of moisture content of black powder.- The moisture content of the black powder shall be determined in accordance with the procedure specified in Specification MIL-P-223.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Preservation and packaging

5.1.1 Level C.-The primer assemblies shall be preserved and packaged in accordance with dwg. 8858940.

5.2 Packing

5.2.1 Level C.-The cartons shall be packed in accordance with dwg. 8858939.

5.3 Marking.-Marking shall be in accordance with dwgs. 8858940 and 8858939.

5.4 Data cards.-Data cards shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with information specified in Specification MIL-A-2550.

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6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.-Procurement documents shall specify title, number and date of this specification.

6.2 Inspection code numbers.-The five digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

6.3 Inspection equipment.-The contractor shall design inspection equipment as required by the referenced Inspection Equipment Lists (IEL) in accordance with the instructions of paragraphs 6.3.1 through 6.3.7.

6.3.1 Inspection equipment lists.-Inspection equipment lists indicate the availability of inspection equipment designs by showing in the "number" column of the list of inspection equipment (OO Form 1242-3) the numbers of drawings of existing equipment designs or codes as indicated in paragraph 6.3.2. Design action required of the contractor with respect to the different types of drawings that may be listed is described in paragraphs 6.3.3 and 6.3.4. Action required by the contractor with respect to commercial inspection equipment is described in 6.3.5. The contractor will be required to prepare detailed drawings in accordance with 6.3.6 for all the equipment coded as "Contractor Design" in the number column. These contractor designs must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.2 Inspection equipment list codes.-The inspection equipment as defined in 6.3.3, 6.3.4, 6.3.5 and 6.3.6 will be designated in the IEL by the following codes:

CDAF - Contractor's design responsibility on Army format in accordance with MIL-D-45608.
CDCF - Contractor's design responsibility on contractor format.
AD - Army design.
ADMU - Army design, mandatory for use.
CE - Commercial equipment.
SCD - Specification control drawing.

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6.3.3 Army designs.-Army designs are reflected on detailed drawings which completely depict all the information necessary for the fabrication of the item of inspection equipment. The contractor need provide no design when an Army design is listed for an item of inspection equipment. Army designs fall into two basic classifications, mandatory and non-mandatory. When an inspection equipment list references mandatory Army designs, the contractor shall comply with, and use these designs accordingly. The contractor may, however, in connection with non-mandatory designs and with the approval of the Government, design alternate inspection equipment or use comparable commercial equipment to facilitate his operations. Such contractor prepared designs or commercial equipment selections must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.4 Specification control drawing.-Specification control drawings depict the minimum equipment requirements in outline, descriptive, diagrammatic or pictorial form only and specify the required performance or other characteristics. Contractors must prepare detailed drawings (see 6.3.6) of their designs in support of specification control drawings. These contractor prepared designs must be approved by the Government prior to the fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Commercial equipment meeting the requirements of specification control drawings may be approved if described in sufficient detail to permit identification and evaluation by the Government. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.5 Commercial equipment.-Commercial equipment is inspection equipment that has universal application for a specific function. It is comprised of items commonly used by industry and Government. Contractors are not required to furnish drawings of commercial inspection equipment, but a list of such equipment must be approved by the Government. Lists shall be submitted for approval to the inspection element of the agency administering the contract.

6.3.6 Contractor designs.-Contractor designs are designs of inspection equipment for which the Government has assigned design responsibility to the contractor. Contractor designs shall be supported by detailed drawings which depict all information necessary

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to completely fabricate, calibrate and operate an item of inspection equipment. This requires that the necessary views, dimensions, materials, finish, notes, operating and calibration instructions be properly depicted in accordance with approved practices to the extent that further calculation or clarification will not be required. Contractor designs identified as CDCF may be developed on the format the contractor normally employs in his equipment design procedure provided such format reflects the detail and information specified above. Contractor designs identified as CDAF shall comply with the format and requirements of MIL-D-45608, and in addition, contain the detail and information specified above. Final approved contractor designs identified as CDCF shall be suitable for microfilming. They must be non-reproducible diazo or electrostatic prints of top quality full size with black line on white background and shall provide a legible print produced via the 35MM microfilm process. Contractor shall submit one copy of the final design as a rolled set or flat set.

6.3.7 Submission of contractor designs.-Designs shall be submitted for approval to the Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SMUPA-ND. Design review will normally be accomplished within one month after receipt by Picatinny Arsenal. Partial submission of inspection equipment designs is permissible and encouraged. However, the Arsenal completion date for design review will be based on the date of the final submission of designs.

6.4 Check test for possible deterioration of percussion artillery primers.-The following tests are designed to prevent the loading of artillery primers which have deteriorated into a major ammunition item. The test shall be performed on artillery primers from each lot which has been stored under normal conditions for more than two years or under adverse conditions for any period of time. If the specification for the ammunition item into which the artillery primers are loaded does not require that the check test be performed, the contracting officer should insert a provision for the performance of the check tests in the contract.

6.4.1 Head assembly

6.4.1.1 Non-functioning (see 3.4.1).-The sampling plan for the test shall be in accordance with Table I. Any head assembly which fails to comply with the applicable requirement shall be

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classed defective. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.1, except that the flash tube and the head assembly shall be separated in a manner that will not damage the head assembly to the extent that the validity of the test results would be questionable. All head assemblies so tested shall be scrapped.

TABLE I

Sample	Sample Size	Size	Combined Samples Acceptance Number	Rejection Number
First	20	20	*	2
Second	20	40	*	2
Third	20	60	0	2
Fourth	20	80	1	3
Fifth	20	100	1	3
Sixth	20	120	1	3
Seventh	20	140	2	3

*No acceptance on this sample

6.4.1.2 Functioning (see 3.4.2).-The sampling plan for the test shall be in accordance with Table II. Any head assembly which fails to comply with the applicable requirement shall be classed defective. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1.2, except that the flash tube and the head assembly shall be separated in a manner that will not damage the head assembly to the extent that the validity of the test results would be questionable.

TABLE II

Sample	Sample Size	Size	Combined Samples Acceptance Number	Rejection Number
First	75	75	*	2
Second	75	150	0	3
Third	75	225	0	3
Fourth	75	300	1	4
Fifth	75	375	2	5
Sixth	75	450	2	5
Seventh	75	525	4	5

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*No acceptance on this sample.

6.4.2 Moisture content of black powder.-A sample of 25 primers shall be selected for this test. The black powder shall be removed from the flash tube by any suitable means. The moisture content of the powder shall be determined in accordance with the method specified in Specification MIL-P-223. If the moisture content of any of the powder tested exceeds 0.7 percent, the lot of primers shall be rejected. Since black powder is hygroscopic, it is advisable to place the powder in a dry, air-tight container immediately upon removal, and to run the determination as soon as possible thereafter.

6.5 Cost of check tests.-The contracting officer will arrange for the contractor to be reimbursed for the expense incurred in the performance of the check test. The test shall be conducted at Government expense without cost to the contractor who loaded the primer element or the contractor loading and assembling the primer, and shall not constitute a basis for rejection against either contractor, except where deterioration has occurred as a direct result of carelessness in handling, storage, etc, while the primers were under the jurisdiction of either contractor.

6.6 Primer assembly functioning and pressure resistance.- In the event that a functioning test fixture is not available, ten sample primers shall be shipped to a government proving ground and fired as part of a complete round for which it is standard, at service pressure, from a weapon for which the round is standard. If any sample primer fails to comply with the applicable requirement, the lot shall be rejected.

6.7 Functioning test reports.-In addition to the normal distribution of records, one copy of primer functioning test results shall be forwarded to: Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, Attn: SMUPA-ND2, Dover, New Jersey.

Custodian:
Army-MU

Preparing Activity:
Army-MU

Project Number: 1390-A470

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ARTILLERY PRIMERS
STANDARDS FOR PAINT CONDITIONS IN FLASH HOLES

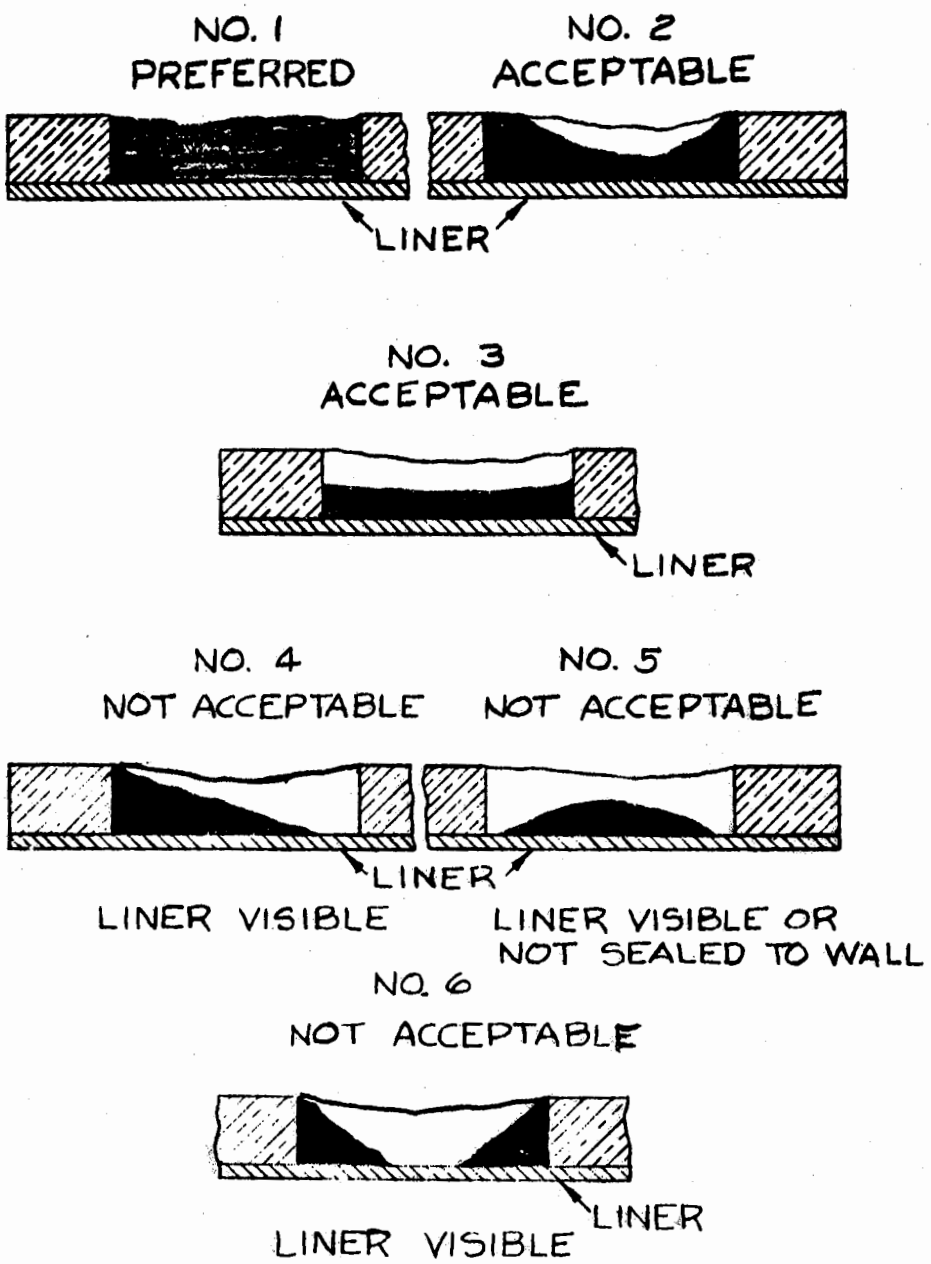


Figure I

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